Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1180

1. Who can vote in Federal elections?

- **A** **any U.S. citizen who is at least 18 years old and meets certain requirements**
- **B** any U.S. resident who is at least 18 years old and meets certain requirements
- **C** any U.S. citizen who is at least 16 years old and meets certain requirements
- **D** any U.S. resident who is at least 16 years old and meets certain requirements

2. The text discusses the extension of voting rights in the United States. What was the sequence of their extension?

- **A** Voting rights were given to all American women, then to African-American men, and then to citizens of the United States who are 18 years of age or older.
- **B** Voting rights were given to all American women, then to citizens of the United States who are 18 years of age or older, and then to African-American men.
- **C** **Voting rights were given to African-American men, then to all American women, and then to citizens of the United States who are 18 years of age or older.**
- **D** Voting rights were given to African-American men, then to citizens of the United States who are 18 years of age or older, and then to all American women.

3. Read these sentences from the text: "When the United States first won its independence, there were restrictions on who could vote. In some states, only white male landowners that were at least 21 years old could vote. Beginning in 1870, a series of Constitutional Amendments and other laws have extended voting privileges to more and more citizens."

What evidence in the text supports the statement that "a series of Constitutional Amendments and other laws have extended voting privileges to more and more citizens"?

- **A** Requirements for voter registration and registration deadlines change depending on where you live in the U.S.
- **B** You can register to vote at motor vehicle or driver's licensing offices and Armed Forces recruitment offices.
- **C** The National Mail Voter Registration Form from the United States Election Assistance Commission allows you to register to vote from anywhere in the United States.
- **D** **The Nineteenth Amendment, ratified in 1920, guaranteed the right to vote to all American women.**

4. Read these sentences from the text: "The Voting Rights Act of 1965 (Public Law 89-110) became effective on August 6, 1965. It enforced the Fifteenth Amendment and outlawed discriminatory voting practices."

Based on this information, what can you infer about the Fifteenth Amendment before the Voting Rights Act?

- **A** The Fifteenth Amendment was popular with a lot of U.S. citizens who were under the age of 21.
- **B** The Fifteenth Amendment was unpopular with a lot of U.S. citizens who were under the age of 21.
- **C** **The Fifteenth Amendment was not being completely obeyed.**
- **D** The Fifteenth Amendment was being completely obeyed.

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5. What is a main idea of this text?

A The Twenty-sixth Amendment, ratified in 1971, lowered the voting age from 21 to 18.
B **The right to vote in the United States was slowly extended to more and more citizens.**
C Many states offer voter registration opportunities at public libraries and post offices.
D When the United States was founded, only white male landowners that were at least 21 years old could vote in some states.

6. Read these sentences from the text: "It took a long time and a lot of hard work to extend the right to vote to every adult citizen in the United States. That's why **it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote**."

What does the author probably mean by writing that "**it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote**"?

A **It is the responsibility of every American citizen who can vote to vote.**
B It is the responsibility of every American who works for the government to vote.
C It is the responsibility of all American voters to respect each other.
D It is the responsibility of all American voters to think carefully when they are voting.

7. Read these sentences from the text: "It took a long time and a lot of hard work to extend the right to vote to every adult citizen in the United States. That's why it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote."

How could the second sentence be rewritten without changing its meaning?

A Currently, it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote.
B Specifically, it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote.
C Instead, it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote.
D **Therefore, it is every eligible American citizen's responsibility to vote.**

8. Read this statement from the text: "It took a long time . . . to extend the right to vote to every adult citizen in the United States."

What evidence in the text supports this statement?

Suggested answer: Answers may vary but should resemble the following. The extension of voting rights began in 1870 and ended in 1971. That was a period of 101 years, which is a long time.

9. Why does the author believe "it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote"?

Suggested answer: The author believes "it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote" because extending the right to vote to every adult citizen in the United States took a long time and a lot of hard work.

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10. Argue for or against the author's claim that "it is every eligible American citizen's civic responsibility to vote." Support your argument with evidence from the text.

Suggested answer: Answers may vary but should be supported by the text. Students arguing for this claim may, like the author, point out the time and effort that have gone into extending voting rights. Because previous generations worked so hard to give all adult U.S. citizens the right to vote, today's citizens owe it to their predecessors, themselves, and their country to exercise their right to vote.

Students arguing against the claim may assert a disconnect. Yes, extending voting rights took a lot of time and effort. Why, though, does that mean all adult U.S. citizens should vote? Maybe voting mattered more to people in the past than to people today. Maybe it matters to some people today but not to others. Why not leave the voting to those who care about it, then? Why should it be "everyone's" responsibility?

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